

Word Choice & Standard Usage

Workbook 2 - Apply - Focused practice

Directions

Treat each item as editing in context. Preserve meaning while fixing grammar, mechanics, and logic.

Exercise 1

The main ____ behind the policy is to protect confidential information.

Task: Choose principle or principal.

- A. principal
- B. principle
- C. principally
- D. principles

Exercise 2

The revised route is shorter ____ the original route.

Task: Choose than or then.

- A. then
- B. than
- C. that
- D. there

Exercise 3

The notice says, "You gotta bring your ID if you wanna enter the lab."

Task: Choose the best formal revision.

- A. You must bring identification to enter the lab.
- B. You gotta bring your ID to enter the lab.
- C. You wanna bring identification for entering.
- D. Identification, you must gotta bring it.

Exercise 4

The audit found ____ errors after the checklist was introduced.

Task: Choose fewer or less.

- A. less
- B. fewer
- C. fewest amount of
- D. lesser

Answer reasoning

Check the rule and the meaning, not only the letter.

For every miss, identify whether the problem was grammar, punctuation, word meaning, sentence logic, or a rushed reading of the context.

Exercise 1

Best answer: B. principle

Why: Principle means a rule or guiding idea. Principal usually means main or a person in charge.

Exercise 2

Best answer: B. than

Why: Than introduces a comparison; then usually refers to time or sequence.

Exercise 3

Best answer: A. You must bring identification to enter the lab.

Why: It preserves the requirement while using concise standard written English.

Exercise 4

Best answer: B. fewer

Why: Errors are countable plural items, so fewer is the standard choice.

Mistake check

Rewrite one missed sentence correctly. Then state the rule in one short sentence you could use on a new example.